of a planned meeting between Gallant and the families of the kidnapped, Netanyahu decided to meet with them immediately. The meeting took place this evening, without anything new coming of it.

The dilemma between ensuring the safety of the hostages and expanding the ground operation remains, even if it is not explicitly acknowledged. It seems that the army is seeking a limited ground operation in northern Gaza as a basis for negotiations. But how limited is limited in a ground operation that has a dynamism of its own? More or less simultaneous with the beginning of the operation, Yehia Sinwar, the head of Hamas in the enclave and planner of the October 7 attack, offered a deal: all for all. In other words, exchange of all the hostages for all Hamas members held by Israel. An Israeli military spokesman rejected Sinwar's proposal, calling it "psychological terrorism." Israel prefers a step-by-step negotiation via Qatar and possibly other mediators.

In a press conference held this evening with Defense Minister Gallant and war cabinet member Gantz, Netanyahu refused once more to take responsibility for the events that led to October 7. He denied again that there was a lack of trust between him and the defense establishment. He repeatedly reaffirmed his certainty of future victory, after which "all the hard questions would be asked." It seems that he has no intention of being held accountable for anything and will fight tooth and nail to keep his position.

Sunday, October 29

In the North, exchanges of fire, but it doesn't seem likely that Hezbollah will join the war beyond that. Iran remains silent for the time being. In Gaza, very little information about the ongoing ground operation. Among the population, there seems to be growing frustration and panic: widespread